

Accreditation Readiness of Non-Accredited Information Technology Programs in Western Visayas: A Provincial and Faculty- Profile Analysis

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ABSTRACT

This article examines the accreditation-readiness results in Lagon's study of non-accredited IT programs in Region VI. The overall reported readiness mean was 4.4590, interpreted as Highly Ready. Age, sex, educational qualification, teaching experience, and academic-rank groups were all classified as Highly Ready. By school location, Aklan, Capiz, Guimaras, and Iloilo were classified as Highly Ready, while Antique and Negros Occidental were classified as Ready. Despite these descriptive differences, inferential testing found no significant readiness differences by age, sex, education, teaching experience, academic rank, or location. The article also clarifies the source's reporting structure: readiness was assessed using the AACUP Preliminary Survey Instrument Area II - Faculty, described as being completed by department directors or heads to produce one set of data per school, while the overall study respondent count was 154. The paper therefore treats the provincial counts as school-level readiness observations as reported in the source and avoids inferring a different denominator.

Keywords: *accreditation readiness, AACCUP, IT programs, Western Visayas, quality assurance, state universities and colleges*

INTRODUCTION

Accreditation readiness was the dependent variable in Lagon's conceptual framework. The source used the AACCUP Preliminary Survey Instrument Area II - Faculty, covering academic qualifications and professional experience; recruitment, selection and orientation; faculty adequacy and loading; rank and tenure; faculty development; professional performance and scholarly works; salaries, fringe benefits and incentives; and professionalism.

This paper isolates the readiness findings and asks whether readiness varied meaningfully across faculty characteristics and school locations.

Overall Readiness by Faculty Characteristics

Grouping Category Mean Source interpretation

Entire group Overall 4.4590 Highly Ready

Age 30 and below 4.4367 Highly Ready

Age Above 30 4.4849 Highly Ready

Sex Male 4.4465 Highly Ready

Sex Female 4.4797 Highly Ready

Education Master's degree 4.5618 Highly Ready

Education Baccalaureate degree 4.4178 Highly Ready

Experience Above 8 years 4.5640 Highly Ready

Experience 8 years and below 4.4221 Highly Ready

Academic rank Part-time instructor 4.4157 Highly Ready

Academic rank Instructor 4.4551 Highly Ready

Academic rank Professor 4.6815 Highly Ready

Readiness by School Location

Location Reported n Mean SD Interpretation

Aklan 2 4.5150 .24749 Highly Ready

Antique 3 4.1833 .67885 Ready

Capiz 2 5.0000 .0000 Highly Ready

Guimaras 1 4.3800 Not reported Highly Ready

Iloilo 14 4.4279 .63894 Highly Ready

Negros Occidental 9 4.0900 .51330 Ready

Five derivative journal manuscripts based on Lagon's published dissertation Page 7

The provincial readiness counts sum to 31 rather than 154. This is consistent with the dissertation's methodological statement that the readiness questionnaire was completed by a director or IT department head to produce one set of data from each school. Because the source also reports an overall readiness figure using the broader respondent framework, this derived paper does not attempt to reconstruct an unreported weighting scheme.

Tests of Readiness Differences

Variable Statistic p value Decision

Age $t = -0.579$.564 Not significant

Sex $t = -0.387$.699 Not significant

Educational qualification $t = -1.530$.128 Not significant

Teaching experience $t = -1.508$.134 Not significant

Academic rank Kruskal-Wallis chi-square = 2.839 .242
Not significant

School location Kruskal-Wallis chi-square = 7.999 .156
Not significant

The inferential results indicate that the observed descriptive variations were not statistically significant at the .05 level. This is particularly important for the provincial data. Although Antique and Negros Occidental fell into the Ready rather than Highly Ready category, the overall location test did not support a statistically significant difference across provinces.

The practical implication is not that all campuses were identical. Readiness checklists are operational tools, and campuses may differ in which documents, processes, or faculty-area requirements are incomplete. Rather, the source evidence does not support a claim that provincial location itself produced different readiness levels.

AACCUP-Oriented Readiness Priorities

Area II faculty sub-area in source Institutional preparation focus

Academic qualifications and professional experience
Degrees, specialization, experience, awards, personnel profiles

Recruitment, selection, and orientation Hiring policies, screening, orientation evidence

Faculty adequacy and loading Licenses, faculty manual, load system, faculty-student ratio

Rank and tenure Promotion, tenure, appointment status, academic rank records

Faculty development Scholarships, training, development program

Professional performance and scholarly works
Evaluation, publications, instructional materials, dissemination

Salaries, benefits, and incentives Compensation and documented faculty support

Professionalism Ethics, academic freedom, professional conduct

CONCLUSION

The source study characterized the faculty area of the non-accredited IT programs as highly ready overall. Descriptive location differences were present, with Antique and Negros Occidental classified one level lower than four other provinces, but no statistically significant readiness differences were found across any examined faculty or location grouping. Accreditation planning should therefore use the Area II checklist to identify specific institutional gaps rather than infer readiness from demographic composition alone.

REFERENCE

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- AACCUP. (2011). Preliminary Survey Instrument, Area II - Faculty. [Instrument identified in the source dissertation.] Five derivative journal manuscripts based on Lagon's published dissertation Page 8